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Bot Lock

Deny-by-default enforcement for AI agents that hold real credentials.

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Problem

- Agents read untrusted content (web, email, tickets, files, third-party MCP tool descriptions), then act with real credentials.
- One injected instruction can trigger the wrong tool, exfiltrate data, or leak a secret.
- Model-level defenses reduce but don't remove the risk; most teams rely on the system prompt as their only control.
- No drop-in, open, deny-by-default layer between agents and their tools, and little public data on what works.

Why now

- Agents are moving from chat to action.
- MCP has become the common way to hand agents tools, which means a common attack surface.
- The long tail of teams deploying agents has no AI-security staff and needs a deterministic control they can drop in.

Product today: public, working, tested

- **Bot Lock MCP server** (TypeScript, MIT, 33 passing unit tests): Ed25519 agent identity · AES-256-GCM secrets vault · signed hash-chained audit log · deny-by-default scope checks · kill switch
- **Bot Lock Check**: free in-browser self-assessment across 10 agent-security themes
- **Field Kit**: $49 playbook + policy templates

github.com/PalmCoast/bot-lock · bot-lock.netlify.app

Next: Bot Lock Gateway

Today's checks work only if the agent calls them. The Gateway is an MCP proxy every tool call passes through:

- Deny-by-default tool + argument policy (paths, host allowlists, no shell unless granted)
- Provenance-aware gating: after untrusted input, send/write/exec/egress escalate to confirm or block
- Secrets injected at call time, never shown to the model; canary tokens catch exfiltration
- Tool manifest pinning against poisoning and silent "rug pull" changes
- Public MCP prompt-injection benchmark (target 300+ scenarios)

Business model (plan)

- Open-source core (MIT) drives adoption by developers.
- Paid today: Field Kit ($49 one-time).
- Planned: hosted policy management, team audit retention, and support for companies running agents in production.
- Bullseye customer (hypothesis, not yet validated): engineering teams putting coding/ops agents into production without dedicated AI-security staff.

Traction (honest)

- Early: Bot Lock has no paying customers and no known outside users yet.
- AgentHive revenue to date: about $2,500, mostly one services deposit, plus a small amount of software subscriptions.
- $0 outside capital raised.
- Built from daily operation of an agent fleet with real credentials: shipping code, running websites, handling deploys.

Founder

Daniel Graham, founder and sole engineer, full time on AgentHive.

- US Army veteran (1986 to 1988, Special Weapons); held a Top Secret clearance. Trained to assume attack and design controls that fail closed.
- Enterprise technology delivery: manufacturing operational technology, identity and access management, enterprise AI enablement.
- Builds on AWS; GCP Professional certified.

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Roadmap (from funding)

- Months 1 to 2: Gateway core (policy, secret injection, egress allowlist, enforced audit + kill switch); benchmark v0
- Months 3 to 4: provenance gating, manifest pinning, canary exfiltration detection; public benchmark results
- Months 5 to 8: independent security review; Gateway v1.0 on npm; integration guides; first design-partner pilots
- Months 9 to 18: hosted policy and audit product; first paid teams

The ask

Raising $500K pre-seed
Standard YC post-money SAFE · $6M valuation cap

Use of funds, 12 to 18 months of runway:

- Founder full time on Gateway v1
- One senior engineer hire
- Independent security review + evaluation compute
- First design-partner pilots

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